



UGANDA FEDERATION OF MOVIE INDUSTRY

Audio Visual Collective Management Organization

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'Revitalizing the film industry in Uganda'

UGANDA FEDERATION OF MOVIE INDUSTRY (UFMI) PROPOSAL FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE UFMI DIGITAL INDUSTRY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

Submitted to: Board of Directors, Uganda Federation of Movie Industry (UFMI)

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BACKGROUND, CHALLENGE & PROPOSED SOLUTION

1. INTRODUCTION

The Uganda Federation of Movie Industry (UFMI) continues to grow in its role of representing and supporting Uganda's film industry. As the number of producers, performers, works and transactions increases, there is a need for the Federation's internal record-keeping and service delivery systems to become more secure, efficient and accountable.

As the **Information & Technology Officer of UFMI**, I propose the development of a **UFMI Digital Industry Management System (UFMI-DIMS)** a secure online platform designed to improve how the Federation manages licences, works, payments and important institutional information.

The purpose of this proposal is **not simply to computerise existing paperwork**, but to establish a reliable digital record that can help protect UFMI, its members, their works and the revenue generated through Federation services.

2. CURRENT CHALLENGES

Licence Tracking and Verification

Currently, when a client presents a receipt, a licence may be issued without an immediate digital mechanism to confirm whether the same receipt has previously been used.

This creates a risk where a receipt or licence may be photocopied or duplicated and presented again, potentially affecting UFMI's revenue and the credibility of its licensing process.

Tracking of Films and Other Works

It can also be difficult to quickly determine whether a particular movie/work has previously been submitted to UFMI, who submitted it, and when it was submitted.

This creates challenges in identifying duplicate submissions and maintaining a reliable history of works handled by the Federation.

Information Security

Important records may currently depend on physical files, individual computers and storage devices. Equipment can fail, become damaged, lost or stolen.

UFMI therefore needs a secure central record that does not depend entirely on one office computer or physical storage device.

Access to Management Information

Generating accurate and up-to-date information on licences issued, revenue generated, payment methods and submitted works can take considerable time when records are primarily manual.

3. PROPOSED SOLUTION

I propose that UFMI develops a **centralised, secure, cloud-based digital management system** through which authorised staff can record, verify, search and manage important Federation information.

The first version will focus on five core areas:

1. **Digital Licence Management**
2. **Works and Ownership Records**
3. **Revenue & Payment Tracking**
4. **Secure Cloud Information Storage**
5. **Management Reports & Information Access**

The system will be developed with future expansion in mind.

KEY SYSTEM FEATURES & BENEFITS

4. DIGITAL LICENCE MANAGEMENT

Every licence issued through the system will have a corresponding digital record containing relevant information such as:

- Unique licence/reference number;
- Client/applicant information;
- Date of issue;
- Relevant work/production;
- Receipt or payment reference;
- Amount paid;
- Method of payment; and
- Authorised staff member responsible for processing.

Once a receipt has been used, its record will remain in the system.

If the same receipt/reference is presented again, authorised staff can search the system and establish whether it has already been used.

This will significantly improve **accountability and protection against duplicate or fraudulent licensing**.

5. LICENCE SECURITY & VERIFICATION

The system can provide digitally generated licences containing security features such as:

- Unique licence number;
- Security/verification code;
- QR code;
- Licence holder information; and
- A digital record against which the licence can be verified.

This means that a photocopy of a licence would not automatically be accepted as proof of validity.

The **official UFMI digital record** would become the primary source for verifying whether a licence is genuine and valid.

6. DIGITAL WORKS REGISTRY

The system will maintain a structured record of works submitted to UFMI.

Information may include:

- Movie/work title;
- Producer;
- Production company;
- Performers and relevant contributors;
- Date of submission;
- UFMI reference number;
- Supporting documents; and
- Ownership information as declared by the applicant.

Before processing a new submission, authorised staff can search existing records to identify whether the same or a similar work has previously been submitted.

This will help UFMI maintain a reliable **history of works submitted through the Federation**.

Important: The system will record and preserve submission history; it will not independently make legal determinations of copyright or ownership.

7. REVENUE & PAYMENT TRACKING

The system will allow UFMI to maintain a digital record of licensing and related transactions.

Authorised users will be able to view information such as:

- Licences issued;
- Revenue recorded;
- Date of transactions;
- Payment method;
- Payment/receipt references; and
- Transaction history.

This will make it easier for management to monitor activities and prepare reports.

8. SECURE CLOUD STORAGE

The system will be hosted on a professionally managed cloud infrastructure.

This provides an additional layer of protection against the loss of information caused by:

- Computer failure;
- Damaged storage devices;
- Theft;
- Accidental deletion; or
- Other physical risks affecting office equipment.

With appropriate authentication, authorised users will be able to access UFMI information without depending on one particular computer.

The system should incorporate appropriate security measures including **user permissions, secure authentication, backups, controlled access and activity records**.

ACCESS, FUTURE DEVELOPMENT & GOVERNANCE

9. EASY ACCESS TO LIVE INFORMATION

Authorised UFMI management and staff will be able to access updated information according to their assigned permissions.

For example, management could quickly establish:

Licensing

- How many licences have been issued;
- Licences issued within a selected period; and
- Relevant licence records.

Revenue

- Revenue recorded;
- Payment methods used; and
- Transaction history.

Works

- Number of works submitted;
- Works submitted by particular producers; and
- Previous submission records.

This will support faster and more informed decision-making.

10. ROLE-BASED ACCESS

The system will not give every user access to everything.

Different levels of access can be created for:

- System administrators;
- Licensing/registration officers;
- Finance personnel;
- Management; and

- Other authorised users.

Important actions can also be logged so that UFMI can establish who created or changed a particular record.

This will strengthen **accountability, confidentiality and institutional control**.

11. FUTURE ONLINE LICENSING

The proposed system will provide a foundation for future online services.

Once UFMI is satisfied with the core system, the platform can progressively be expanded to allow clients to:

1. Apply for a licence online;
2. Submit the required information;
3. Make payment through an approved electronic payment method;
4. Have the application reviewed where necessary;
5. Receive an electronically generated licence in PDF format.

Future payment options could include approved **merchant/mobile payment channels and bank payment arrangements**, subject to UFMI's financial procedures.

This would reduce unnecessary physical visits while making licensing more traceable and convenient.

12. FUTURE MEMBERSHIP & WORKS SERVICES

The platform can later be expanded to support:

- Online membership applications;
- Member information management;
- Membership renewals;
- Online submission of works;
- Digital records of submitted works;
- QR/security verification;
- Automated notifications; and
- Other approved member services.

Where appropriate and legally permissible, UFMI may also explore linking work records with recognized registration/reference systems, including relevant **URSB** information.

13. DATA OWNERSHIP & CONFIDENTIALITY

The system is intended to be a digital platform **for UFMI**.

UFMI should retain control over its institutional records and determine who is authorised to access them.

Any technical service provider should operate under clear terms covering:

- Data ownership;
- Confidentiality;
- Security;
- Access rights;
- Backups;

- Maintenance;
- Data protection;
- Service continuity; and
- Transfer of data if the service arrangement ends.

The objective is to ensure that technology providers support UFMI without compromising the Federation's control over its information.

14. IMPLEMENTATION APPROACH

The system should be implemented progressively.

Phase 1 Core System

- Licence management;
- Receipt tracking;
- Works registry;
- Revenue records;
- User management;
- Search;
- Reports;
- Secure cloud hosting and backups.

Phase 2 Automation

- QR/security verification;
- Advanced reports;
- Notifications;
- Improved dashboards.

Phase 3 Online Services

- Online applications;
- Electronic payments;
- Automatic PDF licences;
- Online membership services.

This approach allows UFMI to start with the most urgent needs while developing the platform according to future requirements.

COST, PARTNERSHIP & BOARD REQUEST

15. PROJECT COST

The proposed system has been costed at:

UGX 1,890,000/=

Cost Breakdown

Component	Amount
System Development, Configuration & Initial Implementation	UGX 1,390,000/=

Component	Amount
First-Year Annual Subscription / Cloud Hosting & Service	UGX 500,000/=
TOTAL INITIAL INVESTMENT	UGX 1,890,000/=

Annual Subscription

From the second year, the proposed recurring subscription will be:

UGX 500,000/= per year

The subscription supports the continued operation of the online system and associated cloud/service infrastructure, subject to the final service agreement.

Any major new features outside the agreed initial scope can be considered separately and approved by UFMI.

16. PROPOSED TECHNICAL DEVELOPMENT PARTNER

For implementation, I recommend that UFMI consider **Natural Intellects LTD** as a technical development partner, subject to the Board's approval and agreement on the final technical and contractual terms.

The focus of this proposal, however, is the **UFMI Digital Industry Management System itself**, rather than the partnership.

The selected developer should provide clear terms covering:

- System ownership and intellectual property;
- Data ownership;
- Security;
- Hosting;
- Maintenance and technical support;
- Training;
- System availability;
- Backup and recovery; and
- Future development.

UFMI should retain the appropriate institutional control over the system and its information.

17. EXPECTED VALUE TO UFMI

The proposed investment will help UFMI move towards a more accountable and professional digital operating environment.

The system is expected to provide:

Better Licence Control

Reduced risk of duplicated receipts and fraudulent licence use.

Better Protection of Works

A searchable institutional record of works submitted to UFMI.

Better Revenue Accountability

Clearer records of licences, payments and revenue.

Better Information Security

Important records protected through secure cloud-based storage and backups.

Faster Access to Information

Authorised staff and management can retrieve current information more easily.

Better Institutional Memory

Important records remain with the Federation rather than depending on individual computers or physical files.

Foundation for the Future

A platform that can eventually support online licensing, membership registration and other digital services.

18. REQUEST TO THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS

I respectfully request the Board of Directors to:

1. **Approve in principle** the development of the **UFMI Digital Industry Management System (UFMI-DIMS)**.
2. Approve the proposed initial investment of **UGX 1,890,000/=**, comprising:
 - **UGX 1,390,000/=** for development, configuration and initial implementation; and
 - **UGX 500,000/=** for the first-year annual subscription/cloud service.
3. Approve the IT Office, working with UFMI management, to proceed with the necessary technical and administrative arrangements for implementation.
4. Consider **Natural Intellects LTD** as the proposed technical development partner, subject to satisfactory agreement on system requirements, security, data ownership, support, hosting and contractual terms.
5. Allow the system to be progressively expanded as UFMI's operational and industry needs develop.

19. CONCLUSION

As the film industry grows, UFMI must have systems that can protect the work, revenue and information entrusted to the Federation.

The proposed **UFMI Digital Industry Management System** provides a practical starting point for achieving this.

It will help UFMI know **what licence was issued, to whom, when and against which payment; what works have been submitted, by whom and when; how much revenue has been recorded; and where important institutional information is kept.**

Most importantly, the system is designed to grow with UFMI.

The proposed investment of **UGX 1,890,000/=** provides the Federation with the foundation for a more secure, transparent and efficient way of managing its services today while preparing for more advanced digital services tomorrow.

This proposal is therefore respectfully submitted to the Board for consideration and approval.

PROTECT THE WORK. PROTECT THE RECORD. PROTECT THE INDUSTRY.

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